

HISTORIC STRIDES

India's rise at the World Para Athletics Championships has been remarkable, with the medal tally growing steadily since the 2017 edition.

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If the previous editions of the World Para Athletics Championships are anything to go by, India's performance at the 2025 edition – set to be hosted by New Delhi this month (September 27 to October 5) – is expected to improve further.

The 2011 and 2013 editions saw India bag just one medal each – Deepa Malik's silver in shot put and Devendra Jhaharia's historic gold in javelin throw respectively. The 2015 edition saw a slight rise in India's tally: two medals courtesy of Jhaharia and Amit Kumar Saroha (club throw), both clinching silvers. However, India's medal haul and position on the final standings have consistently improved since the 2017 edition, which was held in London. As a 73-member strong team prepares to make the most of the home support on offer, we look at the Indian contingent's performance in the last four editions of the World Para Athletics Championships.

2017

London, United Kingdom

1 gold, 2 silver, 2 bronze

The Indian team arrived in England's capital, a year after bagging four medals at the Rio Paralympics, with hopes of bettering its total of two from the previous edition of the Worlds. And within a 10-day span in July, the athletes finished with five medals (1G, 2S, 2B) and ended 34th in the standings.

Sundar Singh Gurjar won India's sole gold of the edition after taking the top spot in the men's javelin throw F46 with a throw of 60.36m.

Saroha (men's club throw F51) and Sharad Kumar (men's high jump T42) accounted for India's silver medals. Saroha fell short of the gold by 1.74m but broke the Area Record with his best throw of 30.25m en route to a second-place finish.

Varun Singh Bhati (men's high jump T42) and Karamjyoti Dalal (women's discus throw F55) won bronze medals. Dalal's best throw of 19.02m had initially placed her fourth, but China's Yang Liwan getting disqualified meant the Indian was bumped up to third.

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